Fall Back! Daylight Saving Time Ends on November 1

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Good news: on Sunday, November 1, 2026, millions of people in North America get a bonus hour. Clocks go back by one hour, ending **Daylight Saving Time** (DST) for this year and returning an extra 60 minutes to the weekend.

The switch also moves more sunlight into the morning, which should make it a little easier to wake up for school or work during the shorter winter days ahead. DST began this year on March 8.

Why do we do this at all? The idea started during World War I. In 1916, the German Empire moved clocks forward to cut artificial lighting and save fuel, and the United States and Britain copied the trick. Countries returned to **standard time** after the war, then brought DST back for World War II.

Then came the messy part. After 1945, the US let states and districts pick their own dates, creating a confusing **patchwork** by 1965, Iowa alone had 23 different sets of start and end dates! The Uniform Time Act of 1966 set one national schedule, though Hawaii, most of Arizona and several US **territories** chose not to take part.

Since 2007, DST has run from the second Sunday in March to the first Sunday in November. About 70 countries observe some form of it, though experts say the twice-yearly change can disrupt sleep and concentration.

Some US states want to stay on DST all year, but that needs **federal** approval. The Sunshine Protection Act would make DST permanent; the House passed it in July 2026 by 308 votes to 117, but the Senate has not approved it yet. Until then: fall back, and enjoy the extra hour.

Word Treasure

Daylight Saving Time -- The practice of moving clocks forward by one hour for part of the year so that evenings get more daylight.

standard time -- The normal clock time used for the rest of the year, when clocks are not moved forward.

patchwork -- A mixture of different pieces that do not match neatly -- here, many different rules for when the clocks change.

federal -- Belonging to the national government of the whole country, not just one state.

territories -- Areas under a country's control that are not full states of that country.

Background you need

Daylight Saving Time is a system of moving the clocks forward by one hour for part of the year, so that the evening stays light for longer.

It began as a way to save fuel: with more daylight in the evening, people needed less artificial lighting.

When the clocks go back in autumn, places return to standard time, and the morning becomes lighter instead.

Because changing the clocks twice a year can disrupt sleep and cause confusion, some people want to stop the switches and stay on one time all year, but that change needs federal approval.

Break it down

LEAD: On Sunday, November 1, 2026, clocks in North America go back by one hour, ending Daylight Saving Time and returning an extra 60 minutes to the weekend

KEY EVENT: The switch to standard time moves more sunlight into the morning, which should make waking up for school or work easier during the shorter winter days

+- ORIGIN: The idea started during World War I; in 1916 the German Empire moved clocks forward to cut artificial lighting and save fuel, and the United States and Britain copied the trick

+- MESSY YEARS: After 1945 the US let states and districts pick their own dates -- by 1965 Iowa alone had 23 different sets -- until the Uniform Time Act of 1966 set one national schedule

+- TODAY: Since 2007, DST has run from the second Sunday in March to the first Sunday in November, and about 70 countries observe some form of it

EVIDENCE: Experts say the twice-yearly change can disrupt sleep and concentration

OPEN QUESTION: Whether DST becomes permanent -- the House passed the Sunshine Protection Act in July 2026 by 308 votes to 117, but the Senate has not approved it yet

Why it matters

Clock changes affect sleep, school and work for millions of people twice a year, and the debate over making Daylight Saving Time permanent would change daily routines across the whole country.

Test what you remember

1. What happens on Sunday, November 1, 2026?

(A) Clocks go back by one hour, ending Daylight Saving Time for the year
(B) Clocks spring forward by one hour
(C) Daylight Saving Time begins again
(D) All US states switch to permanent Daylight Saving Time

2. When did Daylight Saving Time begin this year?

(A) March 8
(B) April 1
(C) January 1
(D) November 1

3. Why did the German Empire first move clocks forward in 1916?

(A) To match Britain's clocks exactly
(B) To give farmers more light in the morning
(C) To help soldiers sleep for longer
(D) To cut artificial lighting and save fuel

4. By 1965, how many different sets of start and end dates did Iowa alone have?

(A) 2
(B) 7
(C) 23
(D) 50

5. What did the Uniform Time Act of 1966 do?

(A) It set one national schedule for the clock changes
(B) It made Daylight Saving Time permanent all year
(C) It let every town choose its own dates
(D) It ended Daylight Saving Time across the US

6. What is the Sunshine Protection Act?

(A) A rule that sets the dates for the clock changes
(B) A plan to ban clock changes in about 70 countries
(C) A proposed law that would make Daylight Saving Time permanent
(D) A law that ended clock changes in Hawaii and Arizona

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: D 4: C 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Experts: They say the twice-yearly clock change can disrupt sleep and concentration.

2. Some US states: They want to stay on Daylight Saving Time all year, but that needs federal approval.

3. The House: It passed the Sunshine Protection Act in July 2026 by 308 votes to 117, which would make DST permanent, but the Senate has not approved it yet.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):